

Alexander Caceres-Wright

+1 212-518-4269 | acacereswright@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [Personal Website](#) | [Google Scholar](#) | [GitHub](#)

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy: Computer Science and Engineering, University at Buffalo (SUNY), Buffalo, New York.

Expected Graduation: June 2028

Advisor: Dr. Kenneth Joseph

Research Areas: Computational Social Science; Large Language Models; Natural Language Processing

Master of Science: Computer Science and Engineering, University at Buffalo (SUNY), Buffalo, New York, June 2024

Bachelor of Arts: Cognitive Systems, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada, May 2022

Minor: Psychology

SKILLS & TOOLS

Large Language Models: Llama, BERT

Data Science Tools: SQL, R, PostgreSQL, Firebase Realtime Database, Pyspark

Programming Languages: Python, Java, C++, C, Haskell, JavaScript

Tools: Git, Jupyter, Visual Studio, LaTeX, Flask, Pandas, Matplotlib

Languages: English (Fluent), Spanish (Fluent)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, cUBe Lab at the University at Buffalo, Buffalo, NY. June 2023 – Present

- Constructed tools for stance detection using Large Language Models applied to 15 million tweets from the 2020 US Presidential Election. Ran experiments to evaluate LLM prompts and parameters.
- Published peer-reviewed paper: A. Caceres-Wright et al., “Explicit Stance Detection in the Political Domain: A New Concept and Associated Dataset”, SBP-BRiMS 2024. **Runner Up: Best Student-Led Paper Award**
- Presented peer-reviewed poster: A. Caceres-Wright, G. Bunn, S. Shuster, and K. Joseph, “Who supports Bernie? Analyzing identity and ideological variation of Bernie supporters on Twitter”, IC2S2 2024.
- Investigating how individuals express identity online and how those who share identities speak about shared topics

Student Assistant, X-Lab at the University at Buffalo, Buffalo, NY. June 2023 – August 2023

- Researched and developed indices of interdisciplinarity using natural language processing
- Completed a literature search aiming to incorporate best previous results into our index

Research in Cognitive Systems, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC. August 2021 – January 2022

- Worked as a research assistant in the Center for Applied Moral Psychology (CAMP) to program a variation of the public goods game using the oTree framework
- Deployed this software to collect data from ~10 games of 4 players each
- Synthesized results and wrote a report of the findings in the context of relevant work

PUBLICATIONS

1. **A. Caceres-Wright**, N. Udhayasankar, G. Bunn, S. Shuster, and K. Joseph, “Explicit Stance Detection in the Political Domain: A New Concept and Associated Dataset”, 2024 International Conference on Social Computing, Behavioral-Cultural Modeling & Prediction and Behavior Representation (SBP-BRiMS)
 - **Runner Up: Best Student-Led Paper Award.**

PRESENTATIONS

1. **A. Caceres-Wright**, and K. Joseph, “Signals of Receptiveness in Discourse on Reddit over 10 Years”, *Poster Presentation*, Rethinking Persuasion: From Social Media to AI Systems Symposium, October 2026
2. **A. Caceres-Wright**, and K. Joseph, “Signals of Receptiveness in Discourse on Reddit over 10 Years”, *Oral Presentation*, 2026 Conference on Complex Systems (CCS), October 2026
3. **A. Caceres-Wright**, G. Bunn, S. Shuster, and K. Joseph, “Who supports Bernie? Analyzing identity and ideological variation of Bernie supporters on Twitter”, *Poster Presentation*, 2024 International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2), July 2024

INVITED TALKS

1. Named Entity Recognition and Stance Detection using Large Language Models. Given to Center for Equitable AI & Machine Learning Systems (CEAMLS), Morgan State University, May 2026.
2. AI in Practice. Given to students in AI 104: Introduction to Computational Expression, University at Buffalo. April 2026.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, University at Buffalo. Buffalo, NY. January 2026 – May 2026

- Developed the first ever offering of *AI 104: Introduction to Computational Expression* alongside the professor
- Alongside regular TA duties I helped develop in class activities and other assessments
- Presented an invited lecture on AI in Practice, discussing common ways LLMs and other AI tools are used in industry

Teaching Assistant, University at Buffalo, Buffalo, NY. August 2025 – December 2025

- Facilitated learning for over 100 students enrolled in CSE 421/521: Operating Systems
- Guided students through two projects implementing operating system fundamentals
- Held weekly office hours to support student learning

Teaching Assistant, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC. January 2020 – December 2020

- Assisted in the delivery of three semesters of CPSC 210: Software Construction
- Duties included running labs, holding office hours, and grading assignments and exams
- Mentored ~30 students per semester as they worked on a semester-long project. Helped guide design and implementation, and helped debug issues, through weekly 1:1 meetings

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Data Analyst (Intern), Quanturisk Analytics Ltd, New York, NY, September 2024 – June 2025

- Joined the company while it was an early stage startup
- Curated high quality corporate dataset with quality controls
- Ran statistical analysis on financial data, used results to identify key financial metrics for further analysis
- Developed financial models to study corporate resilience to sustainability risk
- Created models to accurately predict missing corporate data when necessary
- Designed a matching algorithm to allow data from different sources to be accurately assigned to the correct entities

PROJECTS

Text-to-Speech Application for Low Resource Languages. Python, Huggingface, Transformers

- Created a Text-to-Speech (TTS) system for a low resource Indigenous Language from the Amazon
- Experimented with several different approaches and models, compared end results, and wrote a report summarizing methods and findings

Simulating Trading Models. Python, QuantConnect, Zipline, Pandas, Matplotlib

- Developed simple stock trading models based on various technical indicators such as the Relative Strength Index
- Backtested the models using various frameworks on the stocks of the S&P 500

Museum Interactive Scavenger Hunt. Python, Flask, Firebase Realtime Database, Javascript, CSS

- Implemented a full-stack application for the Niagara Aerospace Museum for visitors to complete a scavenger hunt
- Allows curators to enter or edit clues and exhibits, and visitors to customize the length and difficulty of their hunt

Financial Literacy Application: UB Hacking: Fall 2022 (Hackathon, 1st Place). SQL, JavaFX

- Won first place prize with a prototype JavaFX application aimed at centralizing financial information new immigrants may find useful, such as on banking, Free Application for Federal Student Aid (FAFSA), housing, etc.
- Prompted users with a questionnaire to tailor information they were presented. Stored survey responses in a MySQL database along with a username and password for later retrieval

Pintos Simple Operating System C

- Developed part of an operating system as part of a course
- Implemented several scheduling algorithms, priority donation, memory management, as well as some user interaction

Text Chat Application C++

- Implemented both server and client side methods such as sending and receiving messages, and blocking other clients
- Created functionality to analyze server side statistics including IP addresses, and ports of logged in clients, and tracking of number of sent and received messages

Modeling Internet Packet Protocols C++

- Implemented several packet transmission protocols such as the selective repeat and Go-Back-N
- Analyzed performance of the protocols via testing and summarized findings in a report

Lossy Image Compression C++

- Compressed images using a space partition tree which minimizes color variability across partitions
- Precomputed color statistics for each region

Book Management System. Java, JavaFX

- Allowed users to enter and edit details such as title, author, subject, and length
- Saved and loaded data for use across sessions
- Implemented both a command line and graphical user interface

ACADEMIC SERVICE**Reviewer**, 2026 AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM)**Reviewer**, 2025 International Conference on Social Computing, Behavioral-Cultural Modeling & Prediction and Behavior Representation (SBP-BRiMS).**Reviewer**, 2025 International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2)**Reviewer**, 2024 International Conference on Social Computing, Behavioral-Cultural Modeling & Prediction and Behavior Representation (SBP-BRiMS).UNIVERSITY SERVICE**Student Host Coordinator**, Artificial Intelligence and Society Department, University at Buffalo. October 2025-Present

- Coordinated faculty candidate interviews by liaising between faculty schedulers and PhD students to ensure strong attendance at candidate meetings
- Managed meeting logistics including catering arrangements in collaboration with department administration
- Trained successor coordinators and served as liaison between administrative staff and student volunteers

Mentor. AI For Good Design Challenge. University at Buffalo, October 25–26, 2025**Alumni Mentor**. Cognitive Systems Society, Tri-Mentoring Program. September 2022–PresentAWARDS & HONORS**Runner Up: Best Student-Led Paper Award**. SBP-BRiMS, September 18–20, 2024**First Place Prize, M&T Bank's An Innovative Way to Promote Financial Understanding and Well Being Award**. UB Hacking: Fall 2022 (Hackathon). November 5–6, 2022**Outstanding International Student Award**. University of British Columbia. Academic Year 2017–2018**Second Degree Black Belt, Kyokushin Karate**. Ken Wa Kan Karate, New York City. Achieved March 15, 2015PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP**Member**, Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence (AAAI). September 2025–Present**Member**, Association for Computing Machinery (ACM). January 2023–Present